

Individual Addendum Template
QM 2023 Capstone Project - Milestone 4
Individual Contribution Statement
Name: Samuel Bronner
Team: First Row Team
Date: 5/1/26

1. Personal Contribution to Capstone Milestones

Milestone 1: Data Pipeline (Week 5)

Tasks completed:

- Helped import and organize project datasets
- Completed the AI Audit documentation for this milestone
- Updated the README file to reflect project setup and structure

Hours spent: 5–6 hours

Key deliverable: Imported data, AI Audit, and updated README

Milestone 2: EDA Dashboard (Week 10)

Tasks completed:

- Completed the AI Audit documentation for M2
- Updated the README file with new project developments
- Verified the accuracy and quality of team visualizations

Hours spent: 5–6 hours

Key deliverable: Verified visualizations, AI Audit, and updated README

Milestone 3: Econometric Models (Week 14)

Tasks completed:

- Reviewed feedback from Dr. Seagraves and implemented recommended improvements
- Contributed to improving the overall quality and clarity of the project

Hours spent: 4–5 hours

Key deliverable: Revised and improved project based on instructor feedback

Milestone 4: Final Investment Memo (Week 14)

Tasks completed:

- Assisted Logan with developing and refining the final investment memo

Hours spent: 3–4 hours

Key deliverable: Contribution to final investment memo

Total Estimated Contribution

Total hours across all milestones: 18–21 hours

Percentage of team workload: 25%

Role(s) on team: Data support (M1), Documentation and verification (M2), Quality improvement (M3), Memo support (M4)

2. One Defended Methodological Decision

Decision: I verified and refined visualizations before moving forward with deeper analysis.

Reasoning: Ensuring that our visualizations were accurate and clearly represented the data helped prevent errors in interpretation later in the project. By confirming that trends and relationships were correctly displayed, I built a stronger foundation for our analysis. This approach improved the reliability of our findings and helped the team stay aligned on what the data was actually showing.

Alternative considered: We could have moved directly into deeper analysis or modeling, but without verifying the visuals first, we risked basing conclusions on incorrect or misleading representations of the data.

3. One Key Limitation of Our Analysis

Limitation: Our project relied heavily on the available datasets and may not include all relevant variables.

Why this matters: Missing variables or incomplete data can limit how accurately we explain relationships in the data. Important external factors may not have been captured, which can affect the strength of our conclusions.

Potential mitigation: Future work could incorporate additional datasets or variables to provide a more complete picture and improve the robustness of the analysis.

4. AI Audit Notes (If Applicable)

AI Tools Used: GitHub Copilot

Specific AI Use Examples:

Example 1: Importing Data

Prompt: “Help me import this dataset” (with dataset link included)

Output: Generated starter code to load datasets into the project environment

Verification: I checked that all datasets loaded correctly and matched the original source files in structure and content

Critique: The code worked for basic importing, but it did not fully align with our project structure, so I modified file paths and variable names to fit our workflow

Example 2: README and AI Audit Updates

Prompt: "Help me organize and format this README/AI Audit section"

Output: Provided a structured outline and suggested wording for documentation

Verification: I reviewed all generated content to ensure it accurately reflected our team's actual work and project steps

Critique: Some responses were too general and not specific to our project, so I rewrote sections to make them more precise and relevant

Overall AI Use: I used AI for about 35% of my work, primarily for coding assistance and organizing documentation. I made all final edits and ensured accuracy before including anything in the project.

5. Self-Reflection

What did I do particularly well on this capstone?

I did well in supporting the structure and organization of the project through consistent updates to the README and AI Audit. I also made sure our visualizations were accurate, which helped maintain the reliability of our analysis. Additionally, I contributed to improving the project by carefully applying feedback from Dr. Seagraves.

What could I have improved?

I could have taken a more active role in the analytical and modeling portions of the project. Getting more involved in those areas would have strengthened my overall contribution.

What did I learn from this capstone project?

I learned how important it is to verify data and outputs at each step, especially when using AI tools. I also learned how valuable feedback is in improving a project and how to apply it effectively. Overall, this project helped me better understand teamwork, documentation, and maintaining quality throughout a long-term assignment.

6. Attestation

By submitting this individual addendum, I affirm that:

All contributions listed above are accurate and honest

I have not exaggerated my role or minimized teammates' contributions

I understand that this addendum may be used to adjust my individual grade relative to the team grade

I take full responsibility for my work and any errors in the sections I authored

Signature: Samuel Bronner Date: 5/1/26

